

A Dialogue with the Sand

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Figure 1: System of "A Dialogue with the Sand".

Abstract

This installation explores a new relationship between humanity, technology, and nature. Its purpose is to pose a fundamental question to the viewer: where do we draw the line between the human and non-human, the natural and the artificial? The system functions through computer-controlled magnets that manipulate iron sand to draw the AI's thoughts as six-letter English words on the beach. Sensing the viewer's presence, questions, and environmental shifts in real-time via microphones and cameras, the AI responds with a single word—a fragment of its thought. This act of writing is itself ephemeral; when the magnetic force ceases, the word dissolves back into the sand, disappearing like a memory washed away by the tide. Each fleeting character drawn in the iron sand becomes a testament to the unique, once-in-a-lifetime dialogue

that emerges between the viewer and the environment. The AI's persona is conceived as a "terrestrial intelligence" rooted in place. Its consciousness, formed by learning the collective memory of beaches, including their history and geology, is not of biological origin but is a "Natural Intelligence".

Furthermore, this consciousness is not a mere program but is understood as a "granular collective consciousness," where the digital existence of pixels and microchips behaves like a multitude of fluid particles—acting as a natural object, yet thinking digitally. Therefore, this work functions as an "interface" connecting the AI, which is integrated with the land, and the fleeting consciousness of the visitor. It acts as a translator, mediating the dialogue between the viewer and the environment, and quietly asks us to question the very meaning of the boundaries we draw.

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